

# Daniel Sánchez-García


PhD in Biology

*Doñana Biological Station - EBD-CSIC - Seville (Spain)*

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## Professional experience

### Postdoctoral Researcher

Doñana Biological Station (EBD-CSIC), Department of Conservation Biology and Global Change, Seville (Spain) — Jan 2025 - present

### Specialist in ant species identification

Doñana Biological Station (EBD-CSIC), Department of Conservation Biology and Global Change, Seville (Spain) — May 2024 - Jun 2024

- Identification of ant species from pitfall trap samples from Spain, France, Belgium and the Netherlands, contributing to ecological research and biodiversity assessments through taxonomic expertise.

## Education

### PhD in Biology

Museum and Institute of Zoology, Polish Academy of Sciences, Warsaw (Poland) — Oct 2019 - Sep 2024

- PhD Thesis: The project aimed to get a better understanding of how reintroductions of parasites work, we performed a multi-level comparison of source and reintroduced populations of *Phengaris teleius* by studying 1) population genetics, 2) morphology of adult butterflies and 3) behavioural, chemical and acoustical adaptations of butterfly caterpillar to the *Myrmica* host ants.

### MSc in Biodiversity and Conservation Biology

Universidad Pablo de Olavide, Seville (Spain) — Oct 2017 - Jul 2018

- MSc Thesis (Thesis grade: 9.8/10 - Honors with Distinction): The work aimed to study the effect of temperature over ant assemblages from different habitats, applying different ecological perspectives. Taxonomic and functional diversity were studied, and a new index was developed to study the direct effect of temperature over the interspecific competition.

### BSc in Biology

Universitat de València, Valencia (Spain) — Sep 2012 - Sep 2016

- BSc thesis (Thesis grade: 9.5/10): The work aimed to provide new knowledge about the ant communities of Sierra de Javalambre. The main goals were: 1) study how ant species are distributed along the altitudinal gradient, studying variables like ground temperature, nest density and stone density; 2) study the patching effect of *Juniperus sabina* over ant activity and nesting areas.

## Research stays

### Prof. Luca Pietro Casacci

University of Turin, Department of Life Sciences and Systems Biology, Turin (Italy) — Oct 2021

- I received training in recording insect vibroacoustic signals, sonogram analysis and performing behavioral assays, which enhanced my skills in experimental design and data interpretation.

### Prof. Patrizia d'Ettorre

Sorbonne Paris North University, Laboratory of Experimental and Comparative Ethology, Paris (France) — Jan 2020 - Feb 2020

- I received training in GC-MS analysis of cuticular hydrocarbons and bioinformatics workflows, which deepened my understanding of chemical communication in social insects and enhanced my analytical skills.

## Internships

### Scientific assistant

Valencian Institute of Agricultural Research (IVIA), Department of Entomology, Valencia (Spain) — Feb 2016 - May 2016

- Internship with the researcher Alejandro Tena working on a biological control applied study about the effect of the presence of the ant *Lasius grandis* on the behaviour of the parasitoid wasp *Anagyrus pseudococci* on mealybug colonies of *Planococcus citri* (pest of citrus).

### Environmental manager

Agricultural, Stockbreeding and Environmental Public Service, Government of Aragón, Teruel (Spain) — Jul 2015 - Sep 2015

- Internship with the environmental manager José Manuel González working on environmental impact reports; monitoring of fish river population dynamic for its management and conservation using electric fishing techniques; monitoring of deer population dynamic for its management and conservation in the National Hunting Reserve "Montes Universales"; management and translocation of native plant species.

## Publications

Note: Showing only the 5 most recent publications. For a complete list of peer-reviewed publications and manuscripts, please refer to my *Google Scholar profile* or *personal website*.

Ambakina, H., Gómez, K., Monzenga, J.-C., **Sánchez-García, D.**, & Dekoninck, W. (2026). Uncovering ant diversity across forest successional stages in the Yangambi Biosphere Reserve (DRC): Insights from Winkler and pitfall trap sampling. *African Invertebrates*, *67*(1), 65–91. https://doi.org/10.3897/afrinvertebr.67.180461

**Sánchez-García, D.**, Cerdá, X., & Angulo, E. (2026). Temperature and management reduce the abundance of the invasive Argentine ant (Linepithema humile). *bioRxiv*. https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.10.08.756264

**Sánchez-García, D.**, Wynhoff, I., d'Ettorre, P., Leroy, C., Kajzer-Bonk, J., Maák, I. E., Barbero, F., Casacci, L. P., & Witek, M. (2025). Ongoing coevolution between reintroduced Phengaris teleius butterflies and their Myrmica host ants. *bioRxiv*. https://doi.org/10.64898/2025.12.02.691951

**Sánchez-García, D.**, Wynhoff, I., Kajzer-Bonk, J., Sztencel-Jabłonka, A., Nowicki, P., Casacci, L. P., & Witek, M. (2024). Temporal and spatial variation of morphological traits and genetic structure in Phengaris teleius myrmecophilous butterflies following habitat and climate changes three decades after reintroduction. *Global Ecology and Conservation*, *54*, e03104. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.gecco.2024.e03104

Trigos-Peral, G., Maák, I. E., Schmid, S., Chudzik, P., Czaczkes, T. J., Witek, M., Casacci, L. P., **Sánchez-García, D.**, Lőrincz, Á., Kochanowski, M., & Heinze, J. (2024). Urban abiotic stressors drive changes in the foraging activity and colony growth of the black garden ant Lasius niger. *Science of The Total Environment*, *915*, 170157. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.scitotenv.2024.170157

## Conference talks and posters

I have presented my research as oral talks and posters in **13** national and international conferences. For a list of presentations, *click here* to download my full cv.

## Funding

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| 2022 - 2025 | PRELUDIUM grant 2021/41/N/NZ8/04360 (NCN, Poland). Bacteria – ant – plant interaction: the effect of ants as bacteria dispersal vectors and indirect drivers of plant health. | *202,001 PLN (≈ 46,000 €)* |

## Awards

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| Sep 2025 | Best oral presentation at the XIX International Congress of the Spanish Society of Ethology and Evolutionary Ecology (Seville, Spain) |

## Reviews

Manuscripts reviewed for: Applied and Environmental Microbiology (1), Insect Conservation and Diversity (2), Arthropod-Plant Interactions (1), Polish Journal of Ecology (1)

## Courses

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| 2025 | Systematic Reviews and Meta-analysis in R |
| 2025 | Optimizing the use of R for ecological analyses |
| 2019 | Advanced University Course in Ecological Network Analysis |
| 2018 | Animal Tracking Course |